SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & CONSULTING DEPARTMENT

90-Day Training Roadmap

Thirteen weeks from fundamentals to a full architecture proposal

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90-Day Training Roadmap

Thirteen weeks, one gate every four weeks. Study about 50% and practise about 50% in the first month; move toward supervised real work in the last month.

Week	Focus	Deliverable	Assessment / gate
1	Onboarding, tools, lifecycle overview	Setup done; first diagram started	Setup checklist
2	Level 1: software, networks, cloud, security basics	Notes; Postman collection; DNS trace	Oral quiz
3	Level 2: stakeholders, interviews, objectives	Stakeholder map; mock interview	Mentor review
4	Level 2: requirements, NFRs, acceptance, risks	Requirements for GreenLeaf	Project 1-2 reviewed; Gate: Levels 1-2
5	Level 3: architecture vs design; components; coupling	Classification table	Mentor review
6	Level 3: layered, modular monolith, microservices, events	Project 4 draft	Peer review
7	Level 4: patterns (Chapter 4)	Pattern "when NOT to use" notes	Quiz
8	Level 4 continued; ADRs	Project 7 (ADR)	Gate: Levels 3-4
9	Level 5: application, database, API	Projects 3 and 5	Review
10	Level 5: cloud, network, security, DR	Project 6	Security Architect review
11	Level 6: evaluation; cost; feasibility	Project 8	Gate: Levels 5-6
12	Level 7: governance; shadow a real engagement	Governance notes; shadow log	Mentor
13	Capstone: Project 9 proposal and presentation	Full proposal	ARB-style panel; final sign-off

Scorecard

Dimension	Evidence	Rating (1-5)
Fundamentals	Quizzes, notes	
Analysis quality	Requirements, interview write-ups	
Design reasoning	Options, ADRs	

Dimension	Evidence	Rating (1-5)
Diagrams	Clarity and correctness	
Communication	Presentation, emails	
Professionalism	Honesty about assumptions, confidentiality	

Practical Training Projects

Nine projects, each reviewed by a senior and signed in the trainee log. Use fictional or fully anonymised clients only.

#	Project	Deliverable	Acceptance
1	Basic three-tier application	Diagram + 1-paragraph explanation	Rubric in Chapter 11 ≥ 75
2	C4 system context diagram	Context diagram + interface list	Actors/systems complete; owner confirms
3	Database architecture	ERD, data dictionary, backup and retention plan, RPO/RTO	Normalised; keys defined; restore test described
4	Monolith vs microservices	Comparison matrix + recommendation + ADR	Criteria weighted before scoring; trade-offs honest
5	REST API architecture	OpenAPI skeleton, versioning, auth, error model, rate limit policy	Valid OpenAPI; consistent naming; secured
6	Cloud-hosted application	Deployment + network diagram, cost range with calculator date, DR plan	No single point of failure unaccepted; costs sourced
7	Architecture Decision Record	Complete ADR with 2+ options	Reviewer can understand it cold
8	Technical feasibility assessment	Report (Appendix F) with conclusion and conditions	Evidence per dimension; assumptions labelled
9	Full architecture proposal for a simulated client	Repository with all 20 deliverables (Chapter 8) + 20-minute presentation	ARB-style review passed

Project 9 assessment: full proposal

Area	Weight
Requirements quality and traceability	15%
Options and decision quality	20%
Target architecture and diagrams	20%
Security and operations	15%
Cost and risk analysis	10%
Documentation and repository hygiene	10%
Presentation in business language	10%

CERTIFICATION OF COMPETENCE

Completion of the nine projects plus Levels 1-7 qualifies the trainee as **Junior Technical Analyst (cleared)**. Promotion to Solution Architect additionally needs two supervised real engagements and a Principal Architect sign-off.